

FINAL PROJECT REPORT

An Employee Requests Installation of Licensed Software Through the Service Catalog

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Platform: ServiceNow

Project Version: 1.0

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ServiceNow Software Installation Request Automation

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

The project, “An employee requests installation of licensed software through the Service Catalog,” is a ServiceNow-based automation solution designed to provide a standardized way for employees to request licensed software. The solution replaces informal or manual coordination with a structured Service Catalog request and an automated request lifecycle.

The employee submits the required software information through a dedicated catalog item. The request generates the related Request (REQ) and Requested Item (RITM) records. The configured workflow routes the request for approval and, when approved, creates a Catalog Task (SCTASK) for the Software Support Team. The task is then completed after the software installation activity.

The project also uses Business Rules for backend automation, ServiceNow tables for data handling, and Update Sets for controlled migration of configuration between instances.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose of the project is to make licensed software installation requests simpler, faster, more transparent, and easier to track. The solution provides a consistent request form, captures the required information, automates approval and fulfillment activities, and maintains the request lifecycle within ServiceNow.

- Provide a standardized Service Catalog item for software installation requests.
- Capture Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
- Create and relate REQ, RITM, approval, and SCTASK records.
- Automate approval and fulfillment using the configured workflow / Flow Designer.
- Assign approved fulfillment work to the Software Support Team.
- Support request tracking, completion, and controlled deployment using Update Sets.

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Problem Statement

Employees who need licensed software for work may face delays because software requests require approval and coordination with the IT team. When the process depends on manual follow-up, employees may have limited visibility into the request status and may be uncertain about when the software will be installed.

Final Customer Problem Statement: I am an employee who needs licensed software for work. I’m trying to request and get the software installed quickly through the Service Catalog, but the process can involve manual coordination and approval delays because multiple people and steps are involved, which makes me feel frustrated and uncertain about when my request will be completed.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

The empathy map focuses on the employee as the primary user of the ServiceNow software installation request process. The employee wants a quick and transparent request experience, clear approval status, and timely IT fulfillment.

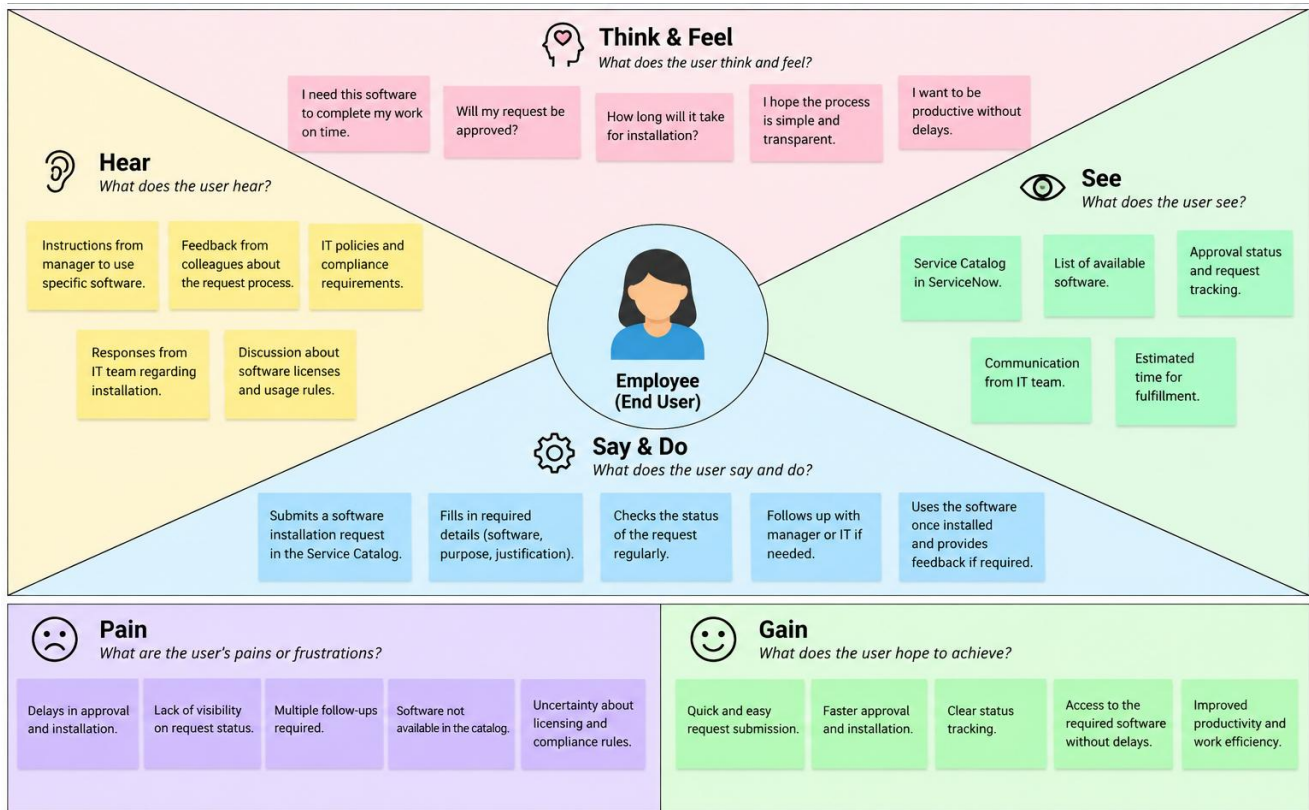


Figure 1. Empathy Map – Employee / Licensed Software Requester

- Needs: fast software installation, clear approval process, and transparent request tracking.
- Pain points: approval or fulfillment delays, manual coordination, and unclear status.
- Expected gain: faster processing, visible status, standardized approval and fulfillment, and a better user experience.

2.3 Brainstorming

Brainstorming was used to identify practical ideas that could reduce manual effort and improve the software request experience. The ideas were grouped into request management, approval, fulfillment, notifications, and tracking.

Idea	Importance	Feasibility
Service Catalog software request form	High	High
Automated manager / authorized approval	High	High
Create Catalog Task after approval	High	High
Request status tracking	High	High
Email / status notifications	Medium	High

Selected idea: automate the licensed software installation request using a ServiceNow Service Catalog item, approval flow, and Catalog Task creation. This idea was selected because it directly addresses the identified problem and can be implemented using standard ServiceNow capabilities.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey Map

The customer journey describes the employee experience from realizing the need for licensed software through request submission, approval, fulfillment, and completion. The key journey stages are Awareness, Request, Approval, Fulfillment, and Completion.

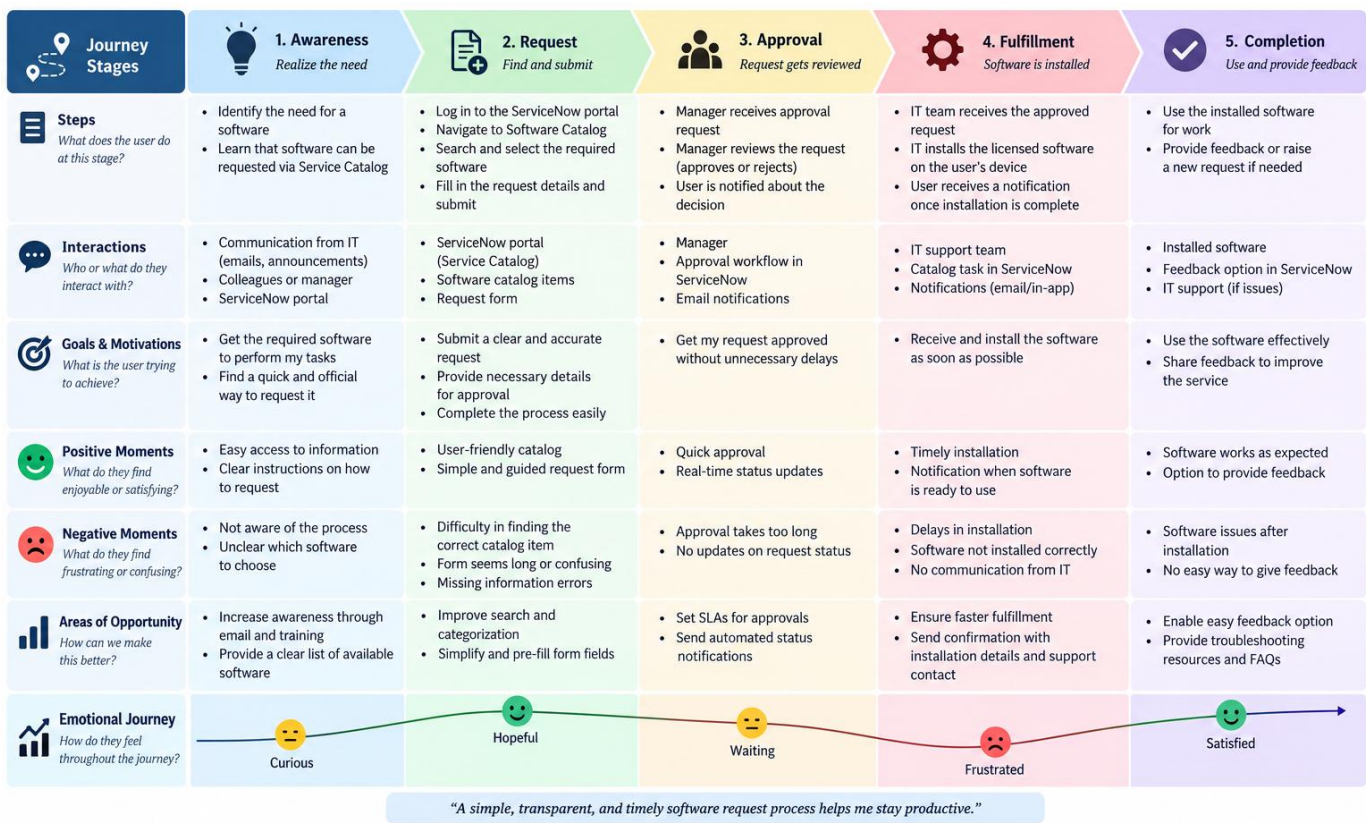


Figure 2. Customer Journey Map – Software Installation Request

The major opportunity areas are to provide a clear Service Catalog item, collect complete request information, automate approval and task creation, provide status visibility, and confirm completion clearly to the employee.

3.2 Solution Requirement

The following functional and non-functional requirements define the expected behavior and quality characteristics of the proposed ServiceNow solution.

Functional Requirements

FR No.	Functional Requirement	Sub Requirement / Expected Behavior
FR-1	Software Request Submission	Create a Service Catalog item; allow the employee to submit the request; capture required software and employee details.
FR-2	Request Processing	Create and manage REQ and RITM records; retain submitted request information and link it to the catalog item.
FR-3	Dynamic Approval	Route the request to an authorized approver; allow approval/rejection; stop normal fulfillment when rejected.
FR-4	Fulfillment Task Creation	Create an SCTASK after approval and assign it to the IT/Software or Software Support Team.
FR-5	Software Installation & Completion	Allow the support team to complete the installation task and update the task/request state.
FR-6	Request Tracking & Notifications	Allow request status tracking and provide relevant submission, approval/rejection, and completion updates.

Non-functional Requirements

NFR No.	Requirement	Description
NFR-1	Usability	The Service Catalog item should be simple, clear, and easy for employees to use.
NFR-2	Security	Only authorized users should access requests and approvals, and software installation should follow approval and security controls.
NFR-3	Reliability	The workflow should consistently process requests without losing request information.
NFR-4	Performance	Submission, workflow execution, approval routing, and task creation should complete within an acceptable response time.
NFR-5	Availability	The Service Catalog and request workflow should be available when employees need to submit requests.
NFR-6	Scalability	The solution should support increased users, requests, and fulfillment tasks without major redesign.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram

The data flow shows how a licensed software request moves through the ServiceNow platform. The employee submits the request through the Service Catalog, ServiceNow creates REQ and RITM records, approval is processed, and an approved request creates an SCTASK for fulfillment.

DFD Level 0 – Software Installation Request Automation

The Data Flow Diagram shows how a software installation request moves through the ServiceNow system, from employee submission through approval and IT fulfillment.

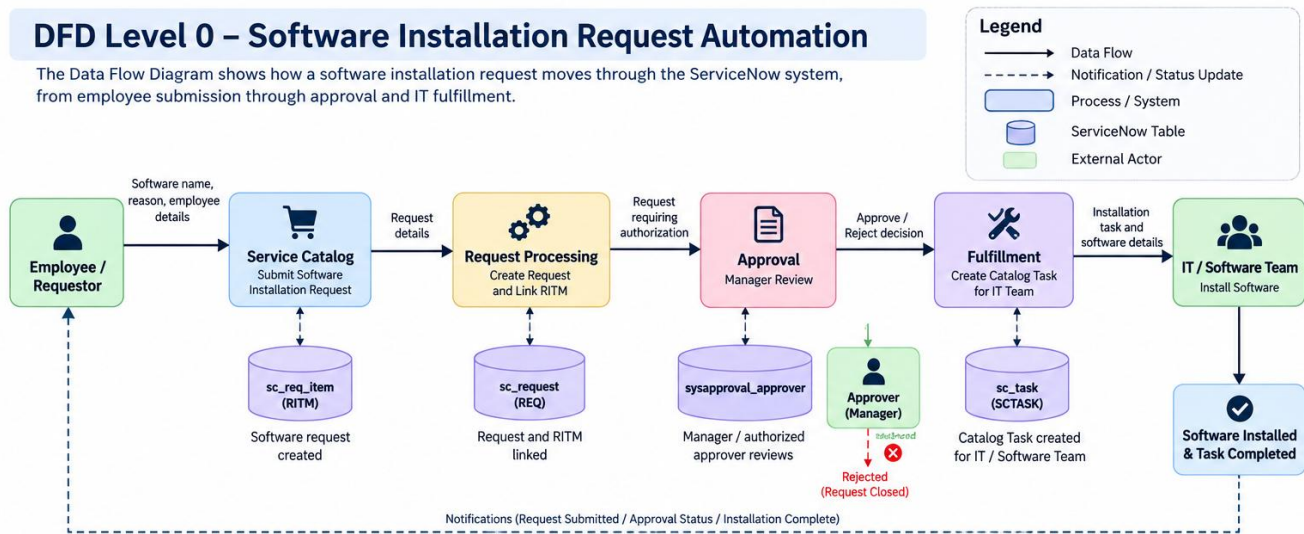


Figure 3. Data Flow Diagram – Software Installation Request Automation

Stage	ServiceNow Record / Table	Purpose
Catalog Request	sc_cat_item	Software installation catalog item
Request	sc_request (REQ)	Stores the overall request
Requested Item	sc_req_item (RITM)	Stores the requested software item and catalog variables
Approval	sysapproval_approver	Stores the approval decision
Fulfillment	sc_task (SCTASK)	Stores the IT / Software Team installation task

3.4 Technology Stack

Component	Technology	Purpose
User Interface	ServiceNow Service Portal / Service Catalog	Employee submits and tracks the software request.
Application Logic	Service Catalog Item + Catalog Variables	Captures Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
Workflow Automation	ServiceNow Flow Designer / Workflow	Controls approval routing and fulfillment sequence.
Fulfillment	Catalog Task (SCTASK)	Represents installation work assigned to the Software Support Team.
Database / Records	sc_request, sc_req_item, sysapproval_approver, sc_task	Stores request, requested item, approval, and task information.
Backend Automation	ServiceNow Business Rules	Supports assignment, status handling, and related backend logic.
Deployment	ServiceNow Update Sets	Packages and migrates configuration between instances.
Infrastructure	ServiceNow PDI / Enterprise Instance	Hosts and executes the application and workflow.

4. PROJECT DESIGN

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The problem-solution fit is achieved by replacing manual coordination with a standardized ServiceNow request and an automated approval and fulfillment process. The solution captures the information required to process a software request, routes it for authorization, creates fulfillment work after approval, and supports tracking.

Canvas Area	Project-Specific Definition
Customer Segments	Employees who need licensed software for their work and use ServiceNow to request IT services.
Job-to-be-Done / Problems	Request the required licensed software, obtain approval, and get it installed through a clear and standardized process.
Problem Root Cause	Software installation requires approval and fulfillment coordination; without automation, manual follow-up can delay the request.
Triggers	A work task, project, application requirement, or other approved business need creates the need for licensed software.
Available Solutions	Service Catalog item, required variables, automated approval workflow, Catalog Task creation, tracking, and notifications.
Customer Constraints	Approval and fulfillment coordination can cause delays; employees need clear visibility into request status.
Behaviour	Employee submits details, waits for approval, checks status, and expects IT/Software Team fulfillment.
Channels of Behaviour	Primary channel is the ServiceNow Service Portal / Service Catalog, supported by approval and status communications.
Your Solution	Standardized catalog item + automated approval + SCTASK creation for the Software Support Team.

4.2 Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is a ServiceNow Software Installation Request catalog item connected to an automated approval and fulfillment flow.

1. Employee opens the ServiceNow Service Catalog and selects the Software Installation Request item.
2. The request form captures Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
3. ServiceNow creates the Request (REQ) and Requested Item (RITM) records.
4. The configured workflow / Flow Designer routes the request to the manager or authorized approver.
5. If the request is approved, ServiceNow creates an SCTASK and assigns it to the Software Support Team.
6. The Software Support Team performs the installation and updates the task to completion.
7. Business Rules and notifications support backend processing and status communication.
8. The configuration is captured in an Update Set so it can be migrated and validated in another instance.

Parameter	Proposed Solution
Problem to be solved	Manual coordination, approval delays, and limited visibility during licensed software installation requests.
Idea / Solution	ServiceNow Service Catalog item with automated approval and fulfillment workflow.
Novelty / Uniqueness	A single standardized request connects catalog data, approval, fulfillment, tracking, and deployment configuration.
Customer Satisfaction	Faster and more transparent request handling with clear ownership and status.
Business Value	Reduces manual coordination and standardizes the software request lifecycle.
Scalability	Additional software items, approval rules, users, and fulfillment tasks can be added on the ServiceNow platform.

4.3 Solution Architecture

The solution architecture connects the employee-facing Service Catalog with the ServiceNow data layer, approval automation, backend logic, fulfillment task, notifications, and Update Set deployment process.

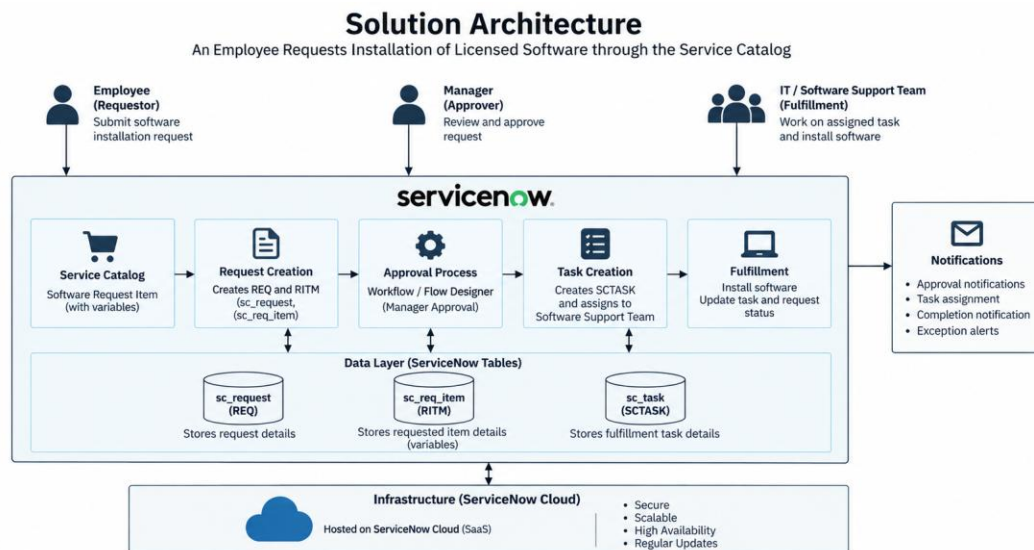


Figure 4. Solution Architecture – ServiceNow Software Installation Request Automation

Component	Purpose
Employee / Requestor	Initiates the licensed software installation request.
Service Catalog	Provides the standardized request item and captures required variables.
ServiceNow Data Layer	Stores REQ and RITM request information.
Approval	Manager or authorized approver reviews and approves/rejects the request.
Workflow / Flow Designer	Controls the automated request, approval, and fulfillment sequence.
Business Rules	Support backend logic such as task assignment and status handling.
Catalog Task (SCTASK)	Represents fulfillment work assigned to the Software Support Team.
Notifications	Communicate important request, approval, and completion status.
Update Sets	Package and migrate configured ServiceNow changes.

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

5.1 Project Planning

The project was organized into four planned sprints with eight user stories and a total of 23 planned story points. The plan covers requirement analysis, Service Catalog configuration, data architecture, approval automation, fulfillment, Business Rules, notifications, testing, and Update Set deployment.

Sprint	User Story	Epic	Story Points	Priority	Planned Scope
Sprint-1	US-01	Requirement Analysis & Planning	2	High	Access standardized Software Installation Request catalog item.
Sprint-1	US-02	Service Catalog	3	High	Capture Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
Sprint-1	US-03	Data Architecture	3	High	Capture and relate REQ, RITM, and SCTASK data.
Sprint-2	US-04	Workflow & Approval	3	High	Allow authorized approver to approve or reject the request.
Sprint-2	US-05	Workflow & Approval	3	High	Continue approved requests to fulfillment and stop rejected requests.
Sprint-3	US-06	Fulfillment & Business Rules	3	High	Create and complete the fulfillment task for Software Support.
Sprint-3	US-07	Business Rules & Notifications	2	Medium	Provide important request and fulfillment updates.
Sprint-4	US-08	Testing, Security & Deployment	4	High	Test, package, migrate, and validate the solution using an Update Set.

Sprint Schedule

Sprint	Story Points	Duration	Planned Scope
Sprint-1	8	Planned	Requirement analysis, Service Catalog, variables, and REQ/RITM data structure.
Sprint-2	6	Planned	Approval workflow and automation logic.
Sprint-3	5	Planned	Catalog Task fulfillment, Business Rules, and notifications.
Sprint-4	4	Planned	Testing, Update Set, migration, and final validation.

Planned total story points: 23. Planned average velocity: 5.75 story points per sprint.

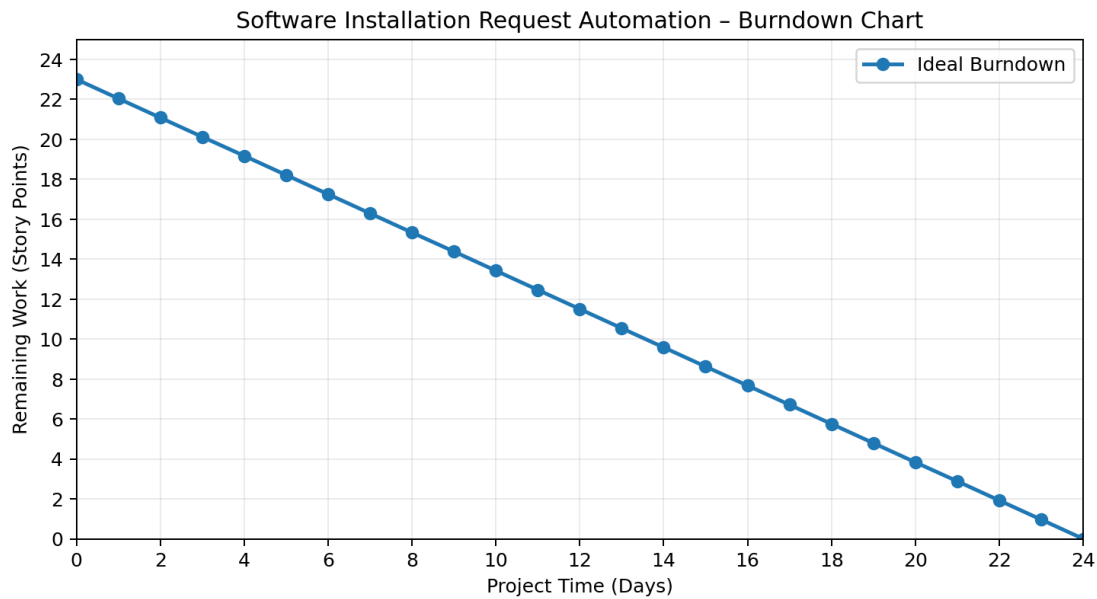


Figure 5. Project Planning / Burndown Representation

Checkpoint	Ideal Remaining Story Points	Actual Remaining
Project Start	23	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-1	15	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-2	9	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-3	4	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-4 / Completion	0	Completed during project execution

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

Performance validation for this project focuses on correct and consistent processing of the software installation request through the Service Catalog, REQ, RITM, approval, SCTASK, automation, and Update Set stages. The testing confirms that the configured flow processes the request without missing records or workflow breaks.

S.No.	Parameter	Validation	Result
1	Service Catalog Item	Catalog item loads correctly and displays the required request fields.	Pass
2	Request Data Capture	Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency are captured.	Pass
3	REQ and RITM Processing	REQ and RITM are created and submitted values are retained.	Pass
4	Approval Workflow	Request reaches the configured approver and approval is recorded before fulfillment.	Pass
5	SCTASK Processing	SCTASK is created after approval, assigned to Software Support, and can be completed.	Pass
6	Automation & Data Integrity	Configured backend automation works and project configuration is captured for deployment.	Pass

Functional validation summary

Test Area	Expected Outcome	Status
Service Catalog & Request Submission	Request item is accessible and required details can be submitted.	Pass
REQ & RITM Processing	REQ and RITM are generated and retain the submitted catalog variables.	Pass
Approval & Fulfillment	Approval is recorded and approved requests create an SCTASK.	Pass
Task Completion	Software Support Team can complete the SCTASK.	Pass
Business Rule / Automation	Configured backend automation executes as intended.	Pass
Update Set & Deployment Readiness	Configuration is captured and prepared for migration.	Pass
End-to-End Validation	Complete lifecycle works from request submission through completion.	Pass

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

The following evidence points should be included in the final submission. The report is structured so that the ServiceNow screenshots can be inserted directly below the corresponding result. The navigation descriptions are aligned with the implemented project flow.

Output 1 – Service Catalog Item

ServiceNow → All → Service Catalog / Maintain Items → open the Software Installation Request catalog item. Show the item and request form.

The screenshot displays the 'Software Installation Request' catalog item form in ServiceNow. The form includes the following fields and sections:

- Header:** Navigation icons, 'Catalog Item Software Installation Request', and action buttons (Copy, Try It, Update, Edit in Catalog Builder, Delete).
- Form Fields:**
 - Name: Software Installation Request
 - Application: Global
 - Catalogs: Service Catalog
 - Category: Software
 - State: -- None --
 - Checked out: -- None --
 - Owner: Srijia Sishtla
 - Secondary owners: (empty)
 - Active: ☒
 - Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified
- Tabs:** Item Details (active), Process Engine, Picture, Pricing, Portal Settings.
- Item Details Tab:**
 - Short description: Request to install company-approved software
 - Description: A rich text editor with the text 'Allows employees to request software installations. Fulfills via Software Support Team.'

Output 2 – Request Submission

<

Service Catalog > Software > Software Installation Request

...

Request to install company-approved software

Allows employees to request software installations. Fulfills via Software Support Team.

What software do you need?

Specify version (if required).

Why do you need this software?

Select urgency level.

Critical

Order this Item

Quantity

1

Delivery time

0 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

Output 3 – REQ

<

Request REQ0010005

...

Follow Update Cancel Request Copy Delete

↑

↓

Number

REQ0010005

Requested for

Srija Sishtla

Location

Due date

2026-09-05 06:22:03

Price

\$0.00

Description

Short description

Opened

2026-09-05 06:22:05

Opened by

Srija Sishtla

Approval

Approved

Request state

Approved

Output 4 – RITM

<

Requested Item RITM0010005

...

Follow Update Delete

↑

↓

Number

RITM0010005

Item

Software Installation Req.

Request

REQ0010005

Requested for

Srija Sishtla

Due date

2026-09-05 06:22:03

Configuration item

Watch list

Opened

2026-09-05 06:22:04

Opened by

Srija Sishtla

Stage

Request Approved

State

Open

Quantity

1

Estimated delivery

Backordered

☐

Order Guide

Variables

What software do you need?

Microsoft Office 365

Specify version (if required).

2026

Why do you need this software?

Required for daily work.

Select urgency level.

High

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Output 5 – Approval

<

≡

Approval

?

↑

≡

⋮

Update

Delete

↑

Approver

Srija Sishtla

State

Approved

Approval for

RITM0010005

Approval Reason

Summary of Item being approved:

Description	Price	Quantity	Total
Request to install company-approved software	\$0.00	1	\$0.00

Comments

Comments

Post

Activities: 2

SS

Srija Sishtla

Field changes • 2026-09-12 05:48:00

State

Approved

 was

Not Yet Requested

SS

Srija Sishtla

Field changes • 2026-09-12 05:47:27

Approver

Srija Sishtla

State

Not Yet Requested

Output 6 – SCTASK

Open the related Requested Item → Catalog Tasks, or navigate to Catalog Tasks and open the generated SCTASK. Show Assignment Group = Software Support and the request item reference.

<

≡

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010008

?

↑

≡

⋮

Follow

Update

Delete

↑

↓

Number

SCTASK0010008

Assigned to

Assignment group

Software

Configuration item

Active☐

Approval

Approved

Priority

-- None --

State

Closed Complete

Request item

RITM0010005

Requested for

Srija Sishtla

Short description

Software fulfillment Task

Description

Work notes

Work notes

☐ Comments (Customer visible)

Post

Activities: 3

SS

Srija Sishtla

Field changes • 2026-09-05 06:29:30

State

Closed Complete

 was

Work in Progress

Software Installation Request Automation | S. Srija Naga Sai

Output 7 – Task Completion

Open the SCTASK → update the task after installation → show State = Closed Complete.

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010008

Number

SCTASK0010008

Assigned to

Q

Assignment group

Software

Q

I

Configuration item

Q

Active

☐

Approval

Approved

Priority

-- None --

State

Closed Complete

Request item

RITM0010005

Q

I

Requested for

Srija Sishtla

Q

I

Short description

Software fulfillment Task

I

C

Description

Work notes

Work notes

I

☐ Comments (Customer visible)

Post

Activities: 3

SS Srija Sishtla

Field changes • 2026-09-05 06:29:30

State Closed Complete was Work in Progress

SS Srija Sishtla

Field changes • 2026-09-05 06:28:49

State Work in Progress was Open

Output 8 – Business Rule / Automation

ServiceNow → All → System Definition → Business Rules → open the configured Business Rule.
Show the rule name, condition, and active configuration.

Business Rule
Create Incident on License Issue

Name

Create Incident on License Issue

Table

Requested Item [sc_req_item]

Application

Global

I

Active

☒

Advanced

☒

When to run

Actions

Advanced

Condition

current.state.changesTo(3)

Script

Turn on ECMAScript 2021 (ES12) mode

```
1 (function executeRule(current, previous /*null when async*/) {
2
3   // Add your code here
4   if (current.state == 3) { // On Hold
5
6     var inc = new GlideRecord('incident');
7
8     inc.initialize();
9
10    inc.short_description = 'License unavailable for ' + current.request_item;
11
12    inc.description = 'Software request could not be fulfilled due to license shortage.';
13
14    inc.caller_id = current.request.requested_for;
15
16    inc.assignment_group.setDisplayValue('Software Support');
17
18    inc.priority = 3;
```

Output 9 – Update Set

ServiceNow → All → System Update Sets → Local Update Sets → open the project Update Set. Show captured configuration and completed state; for migration, show Retrieve Update Sets if applicable.

<

Update Set

Software Installation Request

Update

Back Out

* Name

Software Installation Request

State

Complete

Parent

Release date

Install date

Installed from

Description

Application

Global

Created

2026-09-05 04:50:54

Created by

Sishtla, Srija

Merged to

Update

Back Out

Related Links

Export to XML

Merge With Another Update Set

Scan Update Set

SN Utilis Versions (0)

Customer Updates (15)

Update Set Logs

Child Update Sets

Install History

Created

Search

Update set = Software Installation Request

	Created	Type	View	Target name	Updated by	Remote update set	Action
☐	2026-09-05 05:23:38	Variable		What software do you need?	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:28:06	Variable		Select urgency level.	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:24:57	Variable		Specify version (if required).	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:26:15	Variable		Why do you need this software?	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:29:06	Question Choice		High	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:29:04	Question Choice		Normal	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:31:19	Question Choice		Critical	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:19:34	Catalog Items Catalog		Service Catalog:Software Installation Request	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-05 05:19:35	Catalog Item Category		Software:Software Installation Request	Sishtla, Srija	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages	Disadvantages / Limitations
Standardized software request process.	The solution depends on correct ServiceNow configuration and permissions.
Reduces manual coordination and follow-up.	Approval delays can still occur when an approver does not act promptly.
Captures complete request information using catalog variables.	Actual software installation still requires the Software Support Team.
Automates approval and fulfillment task creation.	Notifications and integrations may require additional configuration for a production environment.
Provides clear ownership through Software Support assignment.	The project does not include external APIs or machine-learning functionality.
Supports request history, status visibility, and controlled deployment.	
Can be extended to additional software and approval rules.	

9. CONCLUSION

The Software Installation Request Automation project successfully demonstrates how ServiceNow can be configured to standardize and automate a licensed software request lifecycle. The solution begins with a structured Service Catalog form, creates REQ and RITM records, routes the request for approval, and generates an SCTASK for the Software Support Team after approval.

The project also demonstrates backend automation through Business Rules, request and task data handling through ServiceNow tables, and configuration migration using Update Sets. Overall, the solution improves process consistency, reduces manual coordination, and gives employees a clearer path from software request to fulfillment.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

- Integrate with a software asset management or license-management system to verify license availability automatically.
- Add dynamic approval rules based on software type, cost, department, or urgency.
- Introduce automatic license availability checks before approval.
- Integrate with endpoint-management tools to automate software installation on employee devices.
- Add SLA monitoring, escalation, and dashboards for request turnaround time.
- Provide richer employee notifications through email and in-app channels.
- Expand the catalog to cover multiple software products and standardized installation packages.
- Add knowledge articles and troubleshooting guidance for common installation issues.

11. APPENDIX

A. Source Code

The project primarily uses ServiceNow configuration, Flow Designer / workflow activities, catalog variables, tables, and Business Rules. The following is the Business Rule logic used in the project to create an incident when the fulfillment process reaches the configured On Hold condition because the requested software license is unavailable.

```
if (current.state == 3) { // On Hold
  var inc = new GlideRecord('incident');
  inc.initialize();
  inc.short_description = 'License unavailable for ' + current.request_item;
  inc.description = 'Software request could not be fulfilled due to license shortage.';
  inc.caller_id = current.request.requested_for;
  inc.assignment_group.setDisplayValue('Software Support');
  inc.priority = 3;
  inc.insert();
}
```

B. GitHub & Project Demo Link

[GitHub Link](#)

[Project Demo Link](#)

D. Core ServiceNow Records Used

Record / Table	Meaning	Project Use
sc_cat_item	Catalog Item	Software Installation Request form.
sc_request	REQ	Overall request record.
sc_req_item	RITM	Requested software item and submitted variables.
sysapproval_approver	Approval	Stores approval decision.
sc_task	SCTASK	Software fulfillment task assigned to Software Support.

E. Acceptance Criteria

- Employee can submit the Software Installation Request through the Service Catalog.
- The catalog captures Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
- A REQ and corresponding RITM are created and linked correctly.
- The request is routed to an authorized approver for an approve/reject decision.
- An approved request creates a Catalog Task for the Software Support Team.
- A rejected request does not proceed to normal fulfillment.
- The Catalog Task contains the required software request information and can progress through completion.
- The configured solution can be packaged and migrated using an Usdate Set.